Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/-james-day (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Strategic Leadership
Shipbuilding
Navy

Certifications

How to Fix Bad Agile
Supply Chain Foundations
Confronting Bias: Thriving Across Our Differences
Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act (DAWIA) Program Management Level III

James Day

Portfolio Acquisition Executive for Mission Systems | Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Navy for Mission Systems
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Summary

I am a results driven member of the Department of War Senior Executive Service (SES) with a solid record of setting bold goals and achieving them. I have over 34 years of experience in Naval operations, maintenance, acquisition and strategic management and use that experience to deliver for the E-1.

I am dedicated to elevating Navy and Marine Corps capabilities through cutting-edge systems integration. My vision revolves around fostering a culture of efficiency, trust, and relentless improvement, empowering the warfighter for mission success. Guided by principles such as focusing on how decisions impact every individual, building and maintaining trust, promoting transparency, fostering teamwork, and practicing professional impatience for high standards, I lead with a commitment to innovation and excellence. I prioritize my family's well-being, fiscal responsibility, social equity, and efficient government service.

In my role, I am responsible for the development and integration of advanced Navy mission systems, overseeing research, development, and acquisition activities, and ensuring compliance with Department of Defense directives. My leadership is marked by open communication, honoring commitments, and a genuine interest in team well-being and professional growth. Through transparency, collaboration, and a focus on collective success, I aim to drive continuous improvement and mission success for the Navy and Marine Corps.

Experience

United States Department of the Navy
Portfolio Acquisition Executive for Mission Systems
May 2026 - Present (2 months)
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Serves as the senior accountable executive for one of the Department of the Navy's largest and most operationally consequential mission portfolios, overseeing the delivery of integrated combat, C4ISR, cyber, electronic warfare, weapons, and mission-enabling systems to Sailors and Marines across the Fleet and Fleet Marine Force.

Leads an enterprise of approximately 2,100 personnel executing more than 500 active acquisition, modernization, sustainment, and rapid capability programs with an annual operating portfolio exceeding $20B. Responsible for end-to-end mission execution across requirements integration, acquisition strategy, technology transition, budget alignment, industrial base engagement, systems delivery, operational readiness, and lifecycle sustainment.

Functions as the single accountable executive for capability delivery to naval warfighters — balancing operational urgency, technical risk, cost, schedule, interoperability, and strategic modernization priorities across a highly complex defense ecosystem.

Directs a portfolio spanning advanced combat systems, AI-enabled capabilities, weapons integration, maritime networks, cyber operations, digital engineering, and next-generation mission architectures. Aligns government, industry, and operational stakeholders to accelerate fielding timelines and drive integrated warfighting outcomes at scale.

Operates at the equivalent of a Fortune 100 CEO/business unit leader level within the federal sector, with responsibility for enterprise transformation, strategic investment decisions, executive stakeholder management and delivery performance across one of the largest mission systems enterprises in government.

Recognized for driving cross-organizational integration and advancing operational capability at the speed demanded by modern naval warfare.

Assistant Secretary of the Navy for Research, Development and Acquisition

Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Navy for Mission Systems

November 2024 - Present (1 year 8 months)

Washington DC-Baltimore Area

The Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Navy for Mission Systems leads the development and integration of advanced mission systems to enhance the

operational effectiveness of the Navy and Marine Corps. This role involves establishing and enforcing policies for research, development, and acquisition activities, guiding and collaborating with senior leadership, and ensuring compliance with Department of Defense directives. The position requires a commitment to building and maintaining trust, promoting transparency, fostering teamwork, and driving continuous improvement. The Deputy Assistant Secretary also represents the Assistant Secretary of the Navy to Congress and the Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition, Technology, and Logistics on matters related to acquisition policy for Mission System programs. This leadership position prioritizes open standards, modularity, innovation, efficiency, and the well-being of team members, ultimately empowering the warfighter for mission success.

As the Deputy Assistant of the Navy for Mission Systems, my vision is to propel Navy and Marine Corps capabilities to new heights through cutting-edge systems integration. I am committed to pioneering a culture of efficiency, trust, and relentless improvement, all while empowering the warfighter and maximizing the impact of Navy and Marine Corps value streams.

Office of the Chief of Naval Operations (OPNAV)
Deputy Director, Surface Warfare Division (OPNAV N96B)
September 2022 - October 2024 (2 years 2 months)
Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Federal Senior Executive position.

As the Deputy Director of the Surface Warfare Division (OPNAV N96B) on the Chief of Naval Operations staff. I am the Chief Executive leading the management of an $120B portfolio delivering readiness and capability for Surface Warfare. My portfolio spans the manpower, training, sustainment, modernization, procurement and operational requirements of the Navy's Surface Warfare force.

Program Executive Office, Integrated Warfare Systems
Director for Production, Deployment and Fleet Readiness
October 2020 - September 2022 (2 years)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Federal Senior Executive position.

As the Executive Director for Production, Deployment and Fleet Readiness I was accountable for the production, deployment and readiness of a $5B surface combat system portfolio with world wide impact.

I successfully transformed the PEO IWS product support and supply chain organization providing 100% visibility in to major program supply chains, expanded visibility into product performance resulting in the improved operational availability for sensor and weapon systems. I turned a foundering cyber accreditation program performing at a success rate of less than 30% into a model Navy program achieving and sustaining cyber accreditation over 94% in less than one year. I conceptualized and drove the establishment of IWS X and initiated the transformation of how the US Navy will deliver surface combat capability for the future. I drove the implementation of the AEGIS and Ship Self Defense System Infrastructure as a Service (successfully demonstrated on USS Winston S Churchill). I led reduction in open critical casualty reports for Navy surface combat systems by over 60%. Built a high performing and diverse team of experts that focus on providing services to PEO Major Program Managers enabling efficient delivery of software and equipment to operational and in construction Navy ships.

PEO Unmanned and Small Surface Combatants (PEO USC)
Deputy Major Program Manager FFG(X) PMS 515
March 2019 - October 2020 (1 year 8 months)
Washington Navy Yard, District Of Columbia

Deputy Program Manager for the Navy's Guided Missile Frigate construction program.

I led the talent acquisition activities for the program hiring over 20 individuals in less than one year. I established multiple and achieved multiple goals for the FFG 62 program. This includes awarding the Navy's first fully competitive ship construction contract four months early with no protests (As acting Major Program Manager). I built a culture of excellence and collaboration through continual communication and servant leadership. I built solid coalitions with internal and external stakeholders. I engaged congress, industry and the media advocating for FFG 62 resources and success.
Presided over two program budget cycles with zero budget reductions. I creatively drove led successful achievement MS B through an innovative two step approach that ensured broad visibility while maintaining competitive information security. I transformed the programs product support strategy to enable the delivery of a war ready ship (ship, crew, weapons and support

infrastructure) upon acceptance. FFG 62 is intended to be the first ship completely ready to enter basic phase training upon delivery.

Assistant Secretary of the Navy For Research, Development and Acquisition Ship Programs

Director for Above Water Sensors, EW and Decoy Programs
September 2016 - March 2019 (2 years 7 months)
Arlington, VA

Director, Above Water Sensors, Electronic Warfare and Decoy Systems, Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Navy, Research, Development and Acquisition, Ship Programs (DASN SHIPS): Demonstrated expert knowledge of Defense Acquisition Management System as the primary advisor to the Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Navy, Research Development and Acquisition, Ship Programs (DASN SHIPS) on Radar, Electronic Warfare, Decoy and Directed Energy systems. In my short period of time with DASN I have successfully guided the Surface Electronic Warfare Improvement Program (SEWIP) Block 1B3 and Block 2 through a Full Rate Production (FRP) design review and am coordinating the AN/SPY-6 Air and Missile Defense Radar (AMDR) Gate Six Configuration Steering Board (CSB), Pre-Low Rate Initial Production (Pre-LRIP) and Milestone C. I am the DASN SHIPS member on the FFRDC committee and I am the lead DASN representative on the DDG 51 Flight III Test and Evaluation IPT charged with resolving contention between D, OT&E and the Navy on Flight III test requirements. I am presently working toward completion of DAU requirements for Science and Technology Manager, Level I Certification.

Program Executive Officer, Integrated Warfare Systems 8.0 (PEO IWS 8.0) Naval Sea Systems Command

Director for Littoral Combat Ship (LCS) Combat Systems
April 2014 - September 2016 (2 years 6 months)
Washington, DC

Demonstrated expertise in Program Management through successful completion program requirements the accomplishment of several first of certifications and live firing events for the LCS program while providing strategic guidance to MPMs and PEOs on the development and integration of Combat Systems within the Navy’s newest surface combatant programs. Using my background and past experience, I successfully established an overall Combat System organization that is credited with delivery and certification of fully functional systems aboard new construction ships and improvements in availability to our ships in sustainment. I successfully

improved communications across program offices; building coalitions and providing Combat System improvements such as the integration of the Surface to Surface Mission Module (SSMM) and the demonstration of computer program portability by aligning the latest new construction computer program baseline with the LCS 3. I provided update too, verification off and approval of all ACAT related inputs to such documents as the DAES Reports and SAR Reports. I provided input and coordination to all CS related inputs to ASN and DASN briefings. I led the submission of combat systems changes for the Fiscal Year 2017 and 2018 LCS Block Buy Ship Production Contracts. I was the primary point of contact for all combat system including planning, development, integration, execution and test. I served as the Acting Deputy Program Manager from November through December 2014 where I orchestrated the organizational move back to the Humphrey's Building and the initial organizational changes for resulting from the Small Surface Combatant Study. I also led the IWS involvement in the development of the Saudi Arabian Multi-Mission Surface Combatant Letter of Offer and Acceptance and the implementation of OPNAV N96 Direction for implementation of the Over-The-Horizon (OTH) Missile Capability into the LCS baseline.

Program Executive Officer, Integrated Warfare Systems 1.0 (PEO IWS 1.0) Naval Sea Systems Command

AEGIS Waterfront Integration and Test Program Manager

December 2010 - April 2014 (3 years 5 months)

Washington, DC

Demonstrated expertise in Program Management through execution of duties within PEO IWS 1.0 where I was responsible for the production, installation and test of all AEGIS Combat System (ACS) installations and modernizations. I led the successful delivery of seven, new construction DDG 51 class ships and successfully completed the first three AEGIS Baseline 9 modernizations. I was responsible for the maintenance of the AEGIS Test Team (ATT) during the DDG 51 production gap. I set the ground work for the successful restart of the DDG 51 production line and new construction test program. I planned, coordinated and delivered the ACS configuration and all supporting material for the DDG 51 Class Fiscal Year 2013 Multi-Year Procurement providing a cost effective plan for continued upgrades to the DDG 51 Class over the next eight years. I provided all Combat System inputs for use in the conduct of gate reviews. I led a diverse team of engineers and scientists in the development of the Technology Insertion 2016 (TI 16) Equipment Suite for use in AEGIS and Ship Self Defense System (SSDS). I was assigned this task at a point where the TI development had fallen behind schedule and was at high risk of missing

production deadlines. I quickly organized the team to focus on two main data products, manufacturing data products and product specifications. I was able to reduce distractions and allow the technical team to deliver products and successfully complete a Critical Design Review (CDR) on schedule. I managed the PPB&E process for the Ship Engineering and Ship Integration budget areas of the DDG 51 wherein I managed an annual budget of over $80 million dollars. I was responsible for the drafting of the Ship Integration and Test follow on contract and the initiation of the TI 16 Common Processor and Common Display contracts.

Program Executive Officer, Integrated Warfare Systems 5.0 (PEO IWS 5.0) Naval Sea Systems Command

Surface Undersea Warfare Advanced Development Program Manager

September 2007 - December 2010 (3 years 4 months)

Washington, DC

Demonstrated Program Management experience through accomplishment of responsibilities associated with the acquisition and execution of the advanced USW systems installed aboard the Navy's surface combatant fleet which includes all DDG-51, CG-47, DDG-1000 and LCS class projects within IWS 5.0. In this time I provided for and led the coordination of several commonality efforts within the surface ship undersea warfare community. My efforts for commonality re-use of current surface ship sonar sensor software applications and efforts to provide DDG-1000, LCS and AN/SQQ-89A(V)15 developing a common core USW technology base across the surface ship platforms. I led the establishment of program dollars to support formation of the Surface USW Advanced Capability Build program. In a results oriented manner, I led the initiation of the Surface USW ACB process through which advanced USW capabilities will be delivered to the fleet on a two year basis and hardware on a four year basis. I tirelessly worked with the fleet and resource sponsor to establish the requirements and funding to provide enhanced ASW capability to the war fighter. In the establishment of the Surface ACB Program, I was able to build a partnership of ASW developers and align the Surface USW community with the Submarine Warfare Enterprise. I participated in the award of the FY07 AN/SQQ-89 Development and Production contract and was responsible for the drafting of the FY11 follow on Development and Production RFP. I performed the duties as Contracting Officers Representative (COR) for the AN/SQQ-89A(V)15 Development Contract. I was the sole program office point of contact for all AN/SQQ-89A(V)15 budget matters including POM submission and reclama development. I was routinely called upon to brief

senior Navy personnel and supported development and delivery of all Armed Services and Appropriation Committee briefings.

Naval Undersea Warfare Center Newport
Program Analyst (Various Positions)
1998 - 2007 (9 years)
Newport, RI

I served as the AN/SQQ-89A(V)15 and 89(V)15 Project Engineer. My notable results include the successful completion of the Operational Evaluation of the 89(V)15 system which achieved the grade of Operationally Effective and Suitable, the delivery of multiple fleet software deliveries and directed the incorporation of over 300 software improvements leading to increased operational stability and functionality of the 89(V)15 and 89A(V)15 ASW Combat Systems. Other assignments within NUWC include positions as Project Manager for the Independent Validation and Verification (IV&V) project, Lead Test and Evaluation Engineer for the AN/SQQ-89(V)15, Light Airborne Multi-Purpose Systems (LAMPS) Test Engineer for the AN/SQQ-89(V)14, a member of the at-sea Test and Evaluation team and a member of the AN/SQQ-89(V)10 staff. I was able to align human and capital resources to improve test efficiency, test planning and reduce overall program cost. I also held several collateral duties including work as a member of the Organizational Architecture Working Group where I participated in the organizational design and strategic plan development of one of the warfare center's largest codes.

Analysis and Technology
Combat System Analyst
1998 - 1999 (1 year)
Newport, RI

Test Technician and Training Technician for Surface Ship Sonar Programs. Performed engineering and developmental testing for United States Navy Surface Ship Sonar Programs. I successfully lead the resolution of over 100 program trouble reports. In doing so improved computer program reliability over 80%. My effort in this area was key to the eventual certification of the AN/SQQ-89(V)10 Surface Undersea Warfare Combat System. I was sought out by senior engineers for my technical and operational expertise and used both to solve critical problems in the Surface USW community.

US Navy
Sonar Technician
1992 - 1998 (6 years)
Various

Training in physics, electronics, mechanics and warfare tactics. Other training and experience includes advanced shipboard fire fighting, management, leadership, finance and budgeting, instruction, security and use of fire arms.

Education

University of Maryland University College

Master of Business Administration - MBA · (2017 - 2018)

Defense Acquisition University

Program Managers Course (PMT 401) · (2018 - 2018)

Defense Acquisition University

Program Managment Level III Certification, Program Management · (2007 - 2009)

Roger Williams University

Bachelor of Science (BS), Computer and Information Systems · (1999 - 2006)

Cornell University

High-Performance Leadership Certificate · (2020 - 2020)